

SCHOOL OF HUMANITIES AND SOCIAL SCIENCES

DEPARTMENT OF POPULATION STUDIES

DEM 1110: INTRODUCTION TO DEMOGRAPHY

TUTORIAL AND STUDY QUESTIONS

TERM 1 TO MIDDLE OF TERM 2

READINGS

Chapter 1: Lucas, David and Paul Meyer, eds. *Beginning Population Studies*. The Australian National University. National Centre for Development Studies.

K. Srinivasan:

Chapter 1: *Basic Demographic Techniques and Applications*: Sage Publications.

Chapter 1 and chapter 3: United Nations. *Determinants and Consequences of Population Trends*. Volume 1. 1973.

Chapters 3, 6, 7, 8 and 16: Weeks, J.R. (1986). *Population: An Introduction to Concepts and Issues*. Belmont, California: Wadsworth Publishing Company.

1. Give a concise definition of demography and explain with, with examples, the difference between formal demography and population studies.
2. Discuss the contributions of the following to the development of demography as a discipline:
 - a) John Graunt
 - b) Thomas Malthus
 - c) Marx and Engels
 - d) American scholars
3. Discuss the interrelationship between demography (or population studies) with other disciplines in the social and biological (or medical) sciences, legal fields, and mathematics.
4. Discuss the relevance of demography in enhancing our understanding of contemporary social, economic, ecological issues and problems with specific focus on the following:
 - a) Unemployment
 - b) Pollution

- c) Inflation
- d) Crime
- e) Housing crisis
- f) Energy crisis
- g) Food crisis

5. What is demographics? Discuss its relevance in:
 - a) Social planning
 - b) Business planning
 - c) Legislative planning
 - d) Political planning
6. Discuss the basic tools of demographic analysis, namely, counts, rates, ratios, proportions, percentages, and probabilities.
7. What are the main sources of demographic data?
8. Define the following concepts:
 - a) Fertility
 - b) Fecundity
9. What are the some of the major causes of fertility?
10. Discuss the following measures of fertility, paying due attention to their strengths and weaknesses:
 - a) Crude birth ratio
 - b) Child – woman ratio
 - c) General fertility rate
 - d) Age specific fertility rate
 - e) Total fertility rate
 - f) Parity
 - g) Complete family size
 - h) Gross reproduction rate
 - i) Net reproduction rate
11. Define the following concepts:
 - a) Mortality
 - b) Morbidity
12. What are some of the major causes of mortality?
13. Discuss the following measures of mortality, paying due attention to their strengths and weaknesses:
 - a) Crude death rate

- b) Age specific death rate
- c) Life expectancy

14. Discuss the following concepts and measures of migration:

- a) Internal migration
- b) International migration
- c) Out – migration
- d) Emigration
- e) In – migration
- f) Immigration
- g) Net migration

15. Discuss some of the push and pull factors in migration.